

AFGHANISTAN

Afghanistan MUN Research Dossier

1. Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Islamic Emirate of Afghanistan (<i>de facto</i>) / Islamic Republic of Afghanistan (<i>previous</i>)
Short Form	Afghanistan
Capital	Kabul
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific
Government Type	De facto Taliban regime (since 2021); unrecognized by the UN
Head of State	Hibatullah Akhundzada (Supreme Leader, Taliban)
Head of Government	Hasan Akhund (Acting Prime Minister, Taliban)
Currency	Afghan Afghani (AFN)
UN Member Since	1946
MUN Standing	Typically represented by pre-2021 republic at UN; issues of legitimacy and humanitarian crisis dominate representation.

Recommended Books on Afghanistan's Foreign Policy and UN Role

1. **"No Good Men Among the Living: America, the Taliban, and the War Through Afghan Eyes"** – Anand Gopal
2. **"Ghost Wars"** – Steve Coll
3. **"Afghanistan: A Cultural and Political History"** – Thomas Barfield
4. **"The Great Gamble: The Soviet War in Afghanistan"** – Gregory Feifer
5. **"Taliban: Militant Islam, Oil and Fundamentalism in Central Asia"** – Ahmed Rashid

Research Table: Afghanistan & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR Country Page – Afghanistan	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/afghanistan	Primary UN hub for monitoring rights in Afghanistan.
Human Rights Watch – Afghanistan	https://www.hrw.org/asia/afghanistan	Independent documentation used by UNHRC.
Amnesty International – Afghanistan Reports	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/asia-and-the-pacific/south-asia/afghanistan/	Reports on abuses under Taliban rule.

UNAMA Human Rights Reports	https://unama.unmissions.org/human-rights	Official UN human rights assessments.
UPR Info – Afghanistan	https://upr-info.org/en/review/Afghanistan	Details Universal Periodic Reviews and recommendations.
Global Rights Compliance – Afghanistan Projects	https://globalrightscompliance.com	Legal research cited in UNHRC commissions.
Norwegian Refugee Council – Afghanistan	https://www.nrc.no/countries/asia/afghanistan/	Displacement rights work referenced at UN.
Center for Civilians in Conflict (CIVIC) – Afghanistan	https://civiliansinconflict.org	NGO reports often cited by UNHRC.
UNHRC Special Rapporteur on Afghanistan	https://www.ohchr.org/en/special-procedures/sr-afghanistan	Monitors Taliban compliance with rights law.
Asia Pacific Forum – Human Rights in Afghanistan	https://asiapacificforum.net	Regional institutions allied with UNHRC.
Geneva Academy – Afghanistan UN Engagement	https://www.geneva-academy.ch	Legal research linked to UNHRC procedures.
UNHCR – Statelessness and Rights in Afghanistan	https://www.unhcr.org/afghanistan.html	Relevant to rights of returnees and IDPs.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Afghanistan Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/afghanistan (ohchr.org)	Official baseline summarizing treaty status and ongoing OHCHR human rights work.
Special Rapporteur on Afghanistan	https://www.ohchr.org/en/special-procedures/sr-afghanistan	Mandate holder's site with reports and updates on violations since May 2022.
OHCHR Presence in Afghanistan	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/afghanistan/our-presence	Outlines OHCHR operations on women's rights, conflict, child protection in-country.

HRW UPR Submission (Oct 2023)	https://www.hrw.org/news/2023/10/11/submission-universal-periodic-review-afghanistan	Shows post-2021 collapse and persecution of women, journalists, and dissenters.
Amnesty Int'l Country Report	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/asia-and-the-pacific/south-asia/afghanistan/report-afghanistan/	Documents worsening rights situation, especially gender-based abuses.
SR's HRC Report (A/HRC/55/80)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/documents/country-reports/ahrc5580-situation-human-rights-afghanistan-report-special-rapporteur	Latest authoritative details on Taliban-era rights violations in HRC.
SR's HRC Report (A/HRC/51/6)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/documents/country-reports/ahrc516-situation-human-rights-afghanistan-report-special-rapporteur	First in series by current SR, establishing baseline in 2022.
State Dept – 2023 HR Report	https://www.state.gov/reports/2023-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/afghanistan/	Covers killings, imprisonment, torture, press suppression, and detentions.
Amnesty – 2024 Public Statement (PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/en/wp-content/uploads/2024/09/ASA1185402024ENGLISH.pdf	Urges international action against impunity, especially gender-based crimes.
UN WebTV – UNAMA Statement	https://media.un.org/unifeed/en/asset/d264/d2647067	Live footage of OHCHR/UNAMA official remarks to HRC on rights collapse.
UPR Stakeholder Report (The Advocates)	https://www.theadvocatesforhumanrights.org/Res/UPR_AHR_Submitted.pdf	Civil society contribution highlighting Taliban abuses in UPR cycle.

HRW on Independent Accountability Proposals	https://www.hrw.org/news/2024/11/26/questions-answers-establishment-independent-international-accountability-mechanism	Explains rationale for an HRC-established accountability mechanism.
UN Women – Gender Country Profile (2024 PDF)	https://www.unwomen.org/sites/default/files/2024-06/Gender-country-profile-Afghanistan-en.pdf	Gender-targeted analysis relevant to Council thematic focus.
Asia-Pacific Gender Report (2024 PDF)	https://www.asiapacificgender.org/sites/default/files/2025-02/National%20Report%20Afghanistan.pdf	Tracks growing barriers for women and legal denial of redress.
Treaty Body Database – Afghanistan	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/countries.aspx?CountryCode=AFG&Lang=EN	Status of key treaty ratifications and overdue reports.
HRW – World Report 2025	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2025/country-chapters/afghanistan	Latest global overview of human rights collapse under Taliban.
State Dept – 2021 HR Report	https://www.state.gov/reports/2021-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/afghanistan/	Pre-Taliban collapse, contextualizing deterioration.
Reuters – 256 Journalist Detentions	https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/un-says-taliban-detained-journalists-over-250-times-afghanistan-since-takeover-2024-11-26/	AP/UN data revealing media suppression—crucial for freedom of expression.
AP – Taliban Rights Obligations Call	https://apnews.com/article/803950c9599de07db0cbd80f846022e5	UNAMA urging Taliban to meet international obligations, especially on female education.

Guardian – Gender Apartheid Protest	https://www.theguardian.com/commentisfree/article/2024/sep/08/the-observer-view-on-afghanistan-britain-and-the-us-are-complicit-in-the-talibans-oppression-of-women	Editorial calling for international accountability via UN mechanisms.
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10 Unique Aspects: Afghanistan at UNHRC

1. **Only Country with “Gender Apartheid” Label by UN Experts:** Experts have labeled the Taliban's exclusion of women from education and public life as “gender apartheid.”
2. **Ongoing Special Rapporteur Presence:** SR Richard Bennett regularly shares HRC reports, like A/HRC/51/6 and A/HRC/55/80, which provide a detailed look at the ongoing tracking of human rights issues.
3. **UNAMA's Council-Level Engagement:** UNAMA often shares engaging updates during HRC sessions, ensuring that Afghanistan remains in the spotlight.
4. **Emerging Push for HRC Accountability Mechanism:** UNAMA often shares engaging updates during HRC sessions, ensuring that the situation in Afghanistan remains in the spotlight. NGO proposals supported by HRW suggest a way forward for an independent mechanism to document the abuses committed by the Taliban.
5. **Complete Collapse of Women's Rights Protections:** OHCHR, HRW, and UN are highlighting the Taliban's actions regarding the removal of women's rights to education and employment.
6. **Systematic Detention of Journalists & Freedoms of Expression:** Since 2021, there have been over 250 detainment incidents, highlighting a troubling level of media suppression during UN discussions.
7. **Severe Mass Humanitarian Crisis:** Over 23 million people are in need of assistance, and 12 million are facing food insecurity. This highlights how closely human rights are linked to humanitarian efforts.
8. **Taliban Membership but Voting Suspended at UN:** The Taliban may have taken control, but the UN continues to recognize the former Republic in diplomatic circles.
9. **Deep Legal Vacuum with No Civil Redress:** The disbanding of the Afghan Human Rights Commission and the elimination of judicial protections have led to a breakdown of the rule of law.
10. **Taliban “Vice & Virtue” Edicts Tighten Control:** New laws on dress, speech, guardianship deepen restrictions—highlighted in SR/HRW reports.